

NEW BALLARD SCORE

Assessment of Neonatal Gestational Maturity

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____ / ____ / ____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____ / ____ / ____ : ____

1. NEUROMUSCULAR MATURITY

1. Posture

- ☐ Extended limbs (-1) (-1)
☐ Slight flexion hips/knees (0) (0)
☐ Moderate flexion (1) (1)
☐ Moderate to strong (2) (2)
☐ Legs flexed & arms (3) (3)
☐ Full flexion (4) (4)

2. Square Window (Wrist)

- ☐ >90° angle (-1) (-1)
☐ 90° angle (0) (0)
☐ 60° angle (1) (1)
☐ 45° angle (2) (2)
☐ 30° angle (3) (3)
☐ 0° full flexion (4) (4)

3. Arm Recoil

- ☐ 180° no recoil (0) (0)
☐ 140-180° slight (1) (1)
☐ 110-140° moderate (2) (2)
☐ 90-110° brisk (3) (3)
☐ <90° immediate (4) (4)

4. Popliteal Angle

- ☐ 180° angle (-1) (-1)
☐ 160° angle (0) (0)
☐ 140° angle (1) (1)
☐ 120° angle (2) (2)
☐ 100° angle (3) (3)
☐ <90° angle (5) (5)

5. Scarf Sign

- ☐ Elbow across body (-1) (-1)
☐ Past midline (0) (0)
☐ At midline (1) (1)
☐ Before midline (2) (2)
☐ Meets firm resistance (3) (3)

6. Heel to Ear

- ☐ Heel reaches ear (-1) (-1)
☐ Near ear (0) (0)
☐ Resistance at 90° (1) (1)
☐ Popliteal resistance (2) (2)
☐ Firm resistance (3) (3)

2. PHYSICAL MATURITY

7. Skin Texture

- ☐ Sticky, friable, transparent (-1) (-1)
☐ Gelatinous, red, translucent (0) (0)
☐ Smooth pink, visible veins (1) (1)
☐ Superficial peeling / rash (2) (2)
☐ Cracking, pale areas (3) (3)
☐ Parchment, deep cracks (4) (4)

8. Lanugo

- ☐ None (-1) (-1)
☐ Sparse (0) (0)
☐ Abundant (1) (1)
☐ Thinning (2) (2)
☐ Bald areas (3) (3)
☐ Mostly bald (4) (4)

9. Plantar Surface

- ☐ Heel-toe 40-50mm (-1) (-1)
☐ >50mm no creases (0) (0)
☐ Faint red marks (1) (1)
☐ Ant transverse crease (2) (2)
☐ Creases ant 2/3 (3) (3)
☐ Creases entire sole (4) (4)

10. Breast Tissue

- ☐ Imperceptible (-1) (-1)
☐ Barely perceptible (0) (0)
☐ Flat areola, no bud (1) (1)
☐ Stippled areola 1-2mm (2) (2)
☐ Raised areola 3-4mm (3) (3)
☐ Full areola 5-10mm (4) (4)

11. Eye / Ear

- ☐ Lids fused (-1) (-1)
☐ Lids open, pinna flat (0) (0)
☐ Slightly curved pinna (1) (1)
☐ Well-curved, soft recoil (2) (2)
☐ Formed & firm, instant (3) (3)
☐ Thick cartilage (4) (4)

12. Genitalia (M/F)

- ☐ Scrotum flat / Clitoris prominent (-1) (-1)
☐ Scrotum empty, faint rugae (0) (0)
☐ Testes in upper canal (1) (1)
☐ Testes descending (2) (2)
☐ Testes down, good rugae (3) (3)
☐ Pendulous / Majora covers (4) (4)

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 50 points (-10 to 50))

Assessor (RN / License #): _____

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

Extreme Preterm (-10 to 10 pts)

20-28 wks. NICU incubator, surfactant, minimal handling protocol.

Moderate Preterm (15 to 30 pts)

30-36 wks. Temperature control, feeding support, phototherapy.

Term / Post-Term (35 to 50 pts)

38-44 wks. Rooming-in, routine screening, breastfeeding support.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment